Ford Motor Company

February 2001

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Safety Recall 01S05: Certain 1999 - 2001 Model Year F-450 and F-550 Super Duty Vehicles Equipped with 19.5-inch Steel Cord Sidewall Tires – Valve Stem Inspection and, If Necessary, Valve Stem and Tire Replacement

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 1999 - 2001 model year F-450 Super Duty and F-550 Super Duty vehicles equipped with 19.5-inch commercial truck tires with steel cord sidewalls, built at the Kentucky Truck Plant from the beginning of model year 1999 through October 21, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

Approximately one percent of the affected vehicles may have been built with a wheel assembly, which may contain a valve stem that was damaged during the automated installation process used at the Kentucky Truck Plant. A damaged valve stem could result in a loss of air pressure and continued use of a steel cord sidewall tire in an under inflated condition could cause permanent damage. Servicing or inflating tires with damaged steel cords could cause a sidewall zipper rupture, resulting in a rapid loss of air pressure that could injure a person(s) near the tire when it happens.

⚠ WARNING

IMPORTANT SAFETY INFORMATION – SERVICING STEEL CORD SIDEWALL TIRES

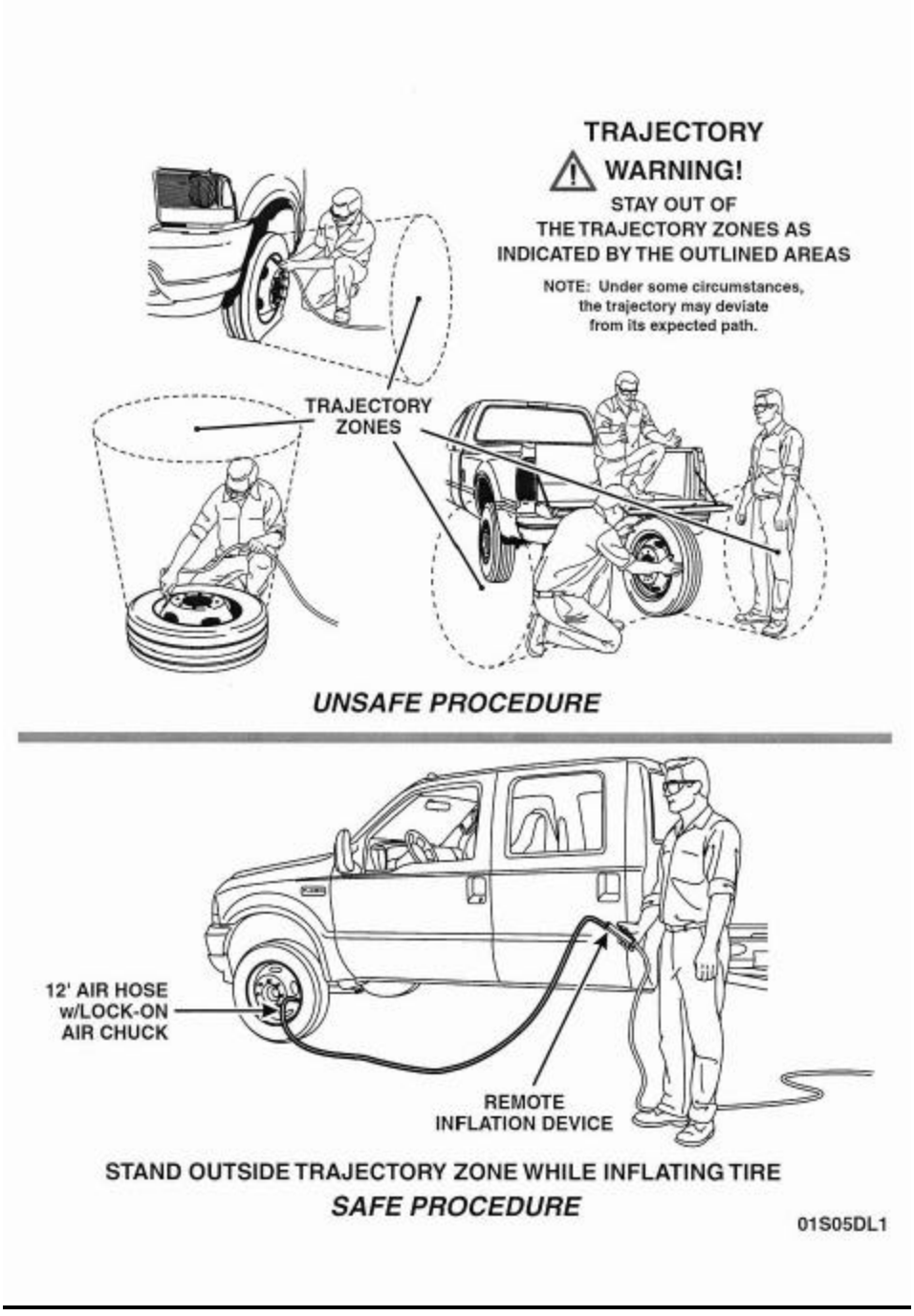
The 19.5-inch steel cord sidewall tires equipped on F-450 and F-550 Super Duty vehicles are made of an **all steel** radial construction, which operate at inflation pressures of up to 95 psi. As such, they are NOT light truck tires and must be serviced with the same safety considerations that are used with other medium/heavy truck all steel radial tires. Personnel trained, supervised, and equipped according to Occupational Safety and Health Administration Standard 29 CFR–1910.177 (Attachment IV) must perform tire service, including adjusting tire pressure. For example, during any procedure involving tire inflation, a technician or individual must utilize a remote inflation device, and insure that all persons are clear of the trajectory area (**See Figure 1**).

SERVICE ACTION

On all affected vehicles brought to the dealer or in dealer stock, the dealer must inspect each valve stem and, if necessary, replace the valve stem and tire for the affected wheel.

NOTE: The tire <u>MUST</u> be replaced in combination with a leaking valve stem since continued use of a 19.5-inch steel cord sidewall tire in a under inflated condition could cause permanent damage to the steel cords, which is <u>not</u> 100% detectable by visual inspection.

In addition, the dealer will adjust the inflation pressure in the remaining tires to the proper specification using the attached recommended fill procedure (Attachment III).



<u>Figure 1</u> Illustrates **<u>unsafe</u>** (upper section), and **<u>safe</u>** (lower section) inflation techniques

SHOP FACILITY REQUIREMENTS FOR DEALER TO PERFORM SAFETY RECALL 01S05

Your dealer must have the following equipment in order to perform this safety recall:

- eye protection
- 12 foot or longer air hose (to be attached to the in-line pressure gauge/chuck)
- clip-on air chuck (Snap-on® tool number YA173A or equivalent)
- in-line air pressure gauge (Snap-on® GA477A or equivalent – you will need to add additional air hose)



- air compressor capable of inflating tires to 95 psi
- secure area of at least 12 feet around vehicle to set tire pressure (**See Figure 1**)

Optional, but highly recommended equipment

- OSHA approved safety cage (most efficient way to service the spare tire)

If your service facility lacks any of the above equipment, it is strongly recommended that you obtain the proper equipment before performing this recall. The equipment listed above (except the OSHA approved safety cage) is necessary to perform the pre-delivery inspection of any F-450 through F-750 truck.

PLEASE NOTE:

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $5,000 per vehicle.

IMPORTANT FACTS

- Approximately 112,000 1999-2001 model year F-450 and F-550 Super Duty vehicles are involved in this campaign. Each affected vehicle must be inspected and, if necessary, repaired.
- We estimate that less than 1% of the affected vehicles will have a valve stem leak and require valve stem and tire replacement. In the rare case, where a vehicle has more than one wheel with a valve stem leak, the dealer must call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 for an approval code to replace additional valve stems and tires. When calling the Recall Hotline be prepared to provide the following information:
  - Dealer P&A code
  - Vehicle Identification Number
  - Valve stem inspection results
  - Tire position on vehicle
  - Repair Order Number
  - Repair Line Number

- ALL dealers are authorized and must inspect valve stems and set tire pressure following the attached recommended inflation procedure (Attachment III).
- Dealers without the proper tire changing equipment may sublet only the wheel to a local truck tire facility.

  Note: Valve stem inspection, tire removal and final inflation must be performed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealer.
- Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealers must obtain the tires for this program, even if they are going to sublet the replace and balance operation.
- Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealers interested in joining the Ford Tire Program may call the Ford Tire Hotline at 1-888-353-3251 for enrollment and program details.
- All 6 valve stems (7 valve stems on vehicles equipped with a spare tire) must be inspected on each affected vehicle.
- All affected wheel and tire assemblies with damaged valve stems should have the tire replaced regardless of the mileage or the remaining tread on the tire.
- Tires removed from vehicles must immediately be rendered unusable (Attachment III).
- In rare cases, where the vehicle is equipped with aftermarket tires from other tire manufacturers, dealers are to inspect the valve stems. If a valve stem is found to be leaking the dealership is to replace the valve stem and the aftermarket tire with the same brand of tire.
- Customers may return to the dealer to have the lug nuts retorqued at 100 miles (160km) and 500 miles (800km). Additional labor operations have been provided (Attachment II).

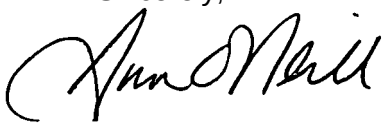
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Attachment IV: **OSHA Standard 29 CFR 1910.177**
Attachment V: Questions and Answers
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
Recall Hotline (Dealer Only) for Approval Codes and Program Questions: . . . 1-800-325-5621
For Around the Wheel/Ford Tire Program Hotline for Tire Orders: 1-888-353-3251

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 01S05: Certain 1999 - 2001 F-450 and F-550 Super Duty Vehicles with 19.5-inch Steel Cord Sidewall Tires - Valve Stem Inspection and, If Necessary, Valve Stem and Tire Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Recall/ONP Involved Units Listings available on QCDealer.com or in the Ford Dealership Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the owner letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

Claims Information

Enter claims in ACES II for vehicles using DWE with the following information:

- Enter information on a **recall** claim type. DO NOT use a warranty claim type.
- Program Code – 01S05.
- Enter **S05TIRE** as the base part and enter the total value of the tire(s) from the "Suggested List Price" column of the latest Ford Motor Company Quarterly Tire Price List.
- Enter **S05STEM** as the base part number for the valve stem, and enter the actual cost.
- Use the appropriate labor operation(s) from Attachment II.
- Tire disposal and applicable local waste tax will be reimbursed – enter OTHER in the miscellaneous expense area of the claim with the actual cost
- **Enter the entire DOT codes and the part number of the replacement tire being used in the comments area of the claim.**

For dealers who sublet the wheel to a local truck tire facility:

- Enter OSL or the Ford published operation (Attachment II) as the labor operation. Enter OSL and the actual cost, not to exceed the Ford published operation amount at the dealer's approved warranty labor rate.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid valve stem repairs made before the date of the owner letter (or after the date of the owner letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Tire replacement that resulted from a leaking valve stem is also refundable. Claims will be audited and additional supporting documentation may be requested by Ford Motor Company. Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Rental vehicle coverage is not provided under this recall.

Safety Recall 01S05: Certain 1999 - 2001 F-450 and F-550 Super Duty Vehicles with 19.5-inch Steel Cord Sidewall Tires - Valve Stem Inspection and, If Necessary, Valve Stem and Tire Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Inspection Operations (Must be completed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealer)		
Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Inspect all valve stems and **no leaks are found**, set all tire inflation pressure to specification.	01S05A	0.4 Hours
Inspect all valve stems and **one or more valve stem(s) leak**, set tire pressure to specification on remaining tires.	01S05B	0.4 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Remove and Install Operations (Must be completed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealer)		
(*Must be performed in conjunction with 01S05B if one or more wheel(s) exhibit a leak at the valve stem*) **Note: Labor times listed include tire disposal.**	Enter these Labor Operations as a "related damage" repair when one (1) or more wheel(s) is removed and installed.	
Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Remove and install one (1) wheel and tire assembly.	01S05C	0.4 Hours
Remove and install two (2) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05D	0.6 Hours
Remove and install three (3) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05F	0.8 Hours
Remove and install four (4) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05G	1.0 Hours
Remove and install five (5) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05H	1.1 Hours
Remove and install six (6) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05J	1.2 Hours
Remove and install seven (7) wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05M	1.4 Hours

Replace Valve Stem/Tire and Balance Wheel Operations (Dealer may sublet to local truck tire facility if they lack proper equipment)		
(*Must be performed in conjunction with 01S05B if one or more tires exhibit a leak at the valve stem*) **Note: All replacement times are based on manual tire removal and installation.**	Enter these Labor Operations as a "related damage" repair when one (1) or more valve stem/tire is replaced.	
Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Replace one (1) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assembly.	01S05N	0.3 Hours
Replace two (2) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05P	0.5 Hours
Replace three (3) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05Q	0.6 Hours
Replace four (4) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05R	0.8 Hours
Replace five (5) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05S	1.0 Hours
Replace six (6) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05T	1.2 Hours
Replace seven (7) valve stem/tire and balance wheel and tire assemblies.	01S05W	1.4 Hours

Claiming Example

Dealer inspects valve stems and finds one (1) leaking valve stem. Dealer would claim **01S05B** as the base operation. Dealer should claim the following operations under related damage:

- **01S05C** for the tire removal and installation
- **01S05N** or **OSL** for the tire replacement and balance procedure

Post-Repair Torque Operation (Must be completed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury Dealer)		
Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Retorque Wheels after 100 miles (160km) of operation	01S05X	0.2 Hours
Retorque Wheels after 500 miles (800km) of operation	01S05Z	0.2 Hours

SPECIAL INSTRUCTIONS FOR POST-REPAIR RETORQUE PROCEDURE

The Owners Guide recommends that each wheel that is removed must have the wheel lug nut torque rechecked at 100 miles (160 km), and again at 500 miles (800 km) after service. To claim this operation, you must file a related damage claim to the original recall claim. Use operation 01S05X for the 100 miles (160 km) retorque procedure, and 01S05Z for the 500 miles (800 km) procedure. The listed labor operations include time to retorque all the lug nuts on all wheels.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Each wheel that exhibits leakage around the valve stem will require valve stem and tire replacement.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
Schraeder®TR 600 HP	Valve Stem (procure locally)	As needed (1) per wheel requiring service
Dill® E-600R	Valve Stem (procure locally)	As needed (1) per wheel requiring service
9002-05682410000 (Ford Tire Program Part Number)	General 225/70 R19.5 F BSW All Season	As required *
9002-05682400000 (Ford Tire Program Part Number)	General 225/70 R19.5 F BSW All Terrain	As required *

* We estimate that less than 1% of the affected vehicles will have a valve stem leak and require valve stem and tire replacement. In the rare case where a vehicle has more than one wheel with a valve stem leak, the dealer must call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 for an approval code to replace additional valve stems and tires. When calling the Recall Hotline be prepared to provide the following information:

- Dealer P&A code
- Vehicle Identification Number
- Valve Stem Inspection Results
- Tire Position on Vehicle
- Repair Order Number
- Repair Line Number

Tire Ordering

Ford Tire Program/AtW Dealers should follow the following steps to secure approved replacement tires:

- Contact their authorized tire distributors to order replacement tires.
- If tires are not available locally through their authorized tire distributors, dealers should contact the Ford Tire Hot Line at 1-888-353-3251 to order additional replacement tires.

Non-Ford Tire Program/AtW Dealers should use the following steps to secure approved replacement tires:

- Contact the Ford Tire Hot Line at 1-888-353-3251 to order replacement tires.

TIRE PRICING

For latest prices on replacement tires, refer to the most recent Ford Motor Company Quarterly Tire Price Guide.

Safety Recall 01S05: Certain 1999 - 2001 F-450 and F-550 Super Duty Vehicles with 19.5-inch Steel Cord Sidewall Tires - Valve Stem Inspection and, If Necessary, Valve Stem and Tire Replacement

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

1. What makes this tire different from other light truck tires?

   Answer: *Typical light truck tires use a nylon ply sidewall. The 19.5-inch steel cord sidewall tires equipped on F-450 and F-550 Super Duty vehicles are made of an **all steel** radial construction. The all steel radial incorporates steel cords in the tire sidewall to add increased load carrying capability.*

2. What does a technician do if the vehicle has steel valve stems installed?

   Answer: *The technician is directed to inspect the stem for leakage, and if no leakage is found continue to adjust the remaining tire pressure to specifications following the inflation procedure listed in Attachment III.*

3. Can I refund a customer who previously paid to have a tire replaced, but the rubber valve stem was not the cause of the repair?

   Answer: *No, Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid valve stem repairs made before the date of the owner letter (or after the date of the owner letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Tire replacement that resulted from a leaking valve stem is also refundable.*

4. The customer has metal valve stem extenders mounted to the rubber valve stems on the dual wheels, and the extender is leaking. What does the dealership do?

   Answer: *If the factory valve stems are not leaking, advise the owner that metal extenders are not recommend for use with rubber valve stems. Disconnect the extenders and adjust the tire pressure to specification following the procedure listed in Attachment III.*

5. I have inspected all of the valve stems and I see a very small bubble when I first move some of the valves. Do we need to replace these valve stems and the tires when this occurs?

   Answer: *A continuous stream of bubbles as the valve is held in a particular position indicates a leak. Due to air entry into the area surrounding the valve stem during assembly, a small non-continuous flow of bubbles as you initially move the valve is a normal condition, and does not indicate a valve stem leak. A true valve stem leak will have a repeatable continuous stream of bubbles when the valve stem is held in a particular position.*

6. I have found a leaking valve stem on a rear inner dual wheel; do I also replace the outer tire to maintain equal tread depth?

   Answer: *No, this recall addresses only the leaking valve stem and the affected tire. Normal tire wear is not covered under this recall.*

7. The owner has installed aftermarket wheels on the vehicle. Does this recall still apply?
   Answer: *No, this recall only applies to original equipment wheels. If the customer chooses to reinstall the original equipment wheels the recall can then be performed.*

8. My dealership is not equipped to replace this type of tire. How can I perform this recall?
   Answer: *Dealers are permitted to sublet the tire replacement and balance portion of this recall. Enclosed is an Instruction Sheet to provide to the sublet repair facility outlining the technical instructions for their portion of the tire replacement and balance procedure (Attachment III). The valve stem inspection, tire removal/installation, and inflation portion of this recall must be performed by a Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealership.*

9. My dealership does not have a remote inflation device or locking air chuck?
   Answer**:** *Remote inflation devices and locking air chucks are available through most aftermarket tool supplies. OSHA Regulation (Standards 29 CFR 1910.177) requires your dealership to provide this equipment for any repair requiring the inflation of steel cord sidewall tires. The regulation also requires that every employee involved in the inflation or service of this tire be instructed in the proper service procedures, a copy of the standard has been attached for your reference (Attachment IV).*

10. The vehicle has a tire that appears to have some form of damage or a defect, but the valve stem on that wheel is not leaking. Can the dealer replace the tire as part of this recall?
    Answer: *No, this recall addresses only the leaking valve stem and the affected tire. Any other damage or defect may be covered under any remaining tire manufacturer warranty.*

11. A truck with a 16-inch wheel has a valve stem leak. Why wasn't this size of wheel included under this recall?
    Answer: *16-inch wheels do not use an all-steel sidewall tire and therefore, do not pose the same risk to personnel servicing the tire.*

12. Why is Ford Motor Company requiring the tire to be replaced if I find a leaking valve stem?
    Answer: *There is no 100% reliable way for a service technician to inspect the tire to see if damage to the sidewall has occurred. Because air leakage from a valve stem could cause low inflation pressure for an extended period of time, which could have led to sidewall damage, the service technician will replace the tire as an added precaution.*

13. The vehicle comes in with a flat tire. Should I inflate the tire and then inspect the valve stem for leakage?
    Answer: *No, there is no way for you to be sure about the sidewall condition. If you do not see any visible signs of road hazard damage, replace the tire and valve stem.*

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

February 2001

01S05

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1999 - 2001 model year F-450 Super Duty and F-550 Super Duty vehicles equipped with 19.5-inch commercial truck tires with steel cord sidewalls.

What the safety issue is …

Affected vehicles may have been built with a wheel assembly, which could contain a valve stem that was damaged during the automated installation process used at the assembly plant. A damaged valve stem could result in a loss of air pressure and continued use of a steel cord sidewall tire in an under inflated condition could cause permanent damage. Servicing or inflating tires with damaged steel cords could cause a sidewall zipper rupture, resulting in a rapid loss of air pressure that could injure a person(s) near the tire when it happens.

Important safety information regarding your vehicle's tires…

The 19.5-inch steel cord sidewall tires equipped on F-450 and F-550 Super Duty vehicles are made of an **all steel** radial construction, which operate at inflation pressures up to 95 psi. As such, they are NOT light truck tires and must be serviced with the same safety considerations that are used with other medium/heavy truck all steel radial tires. Personnel trained, supervised, and equipped according to Occupation Safety and Health Administration (OSHA) Standard 29 CFR-1910.177, must perform tire service, including adjusting tire pressure. For example, during any procedure involving tire inflation, a technician or individual must utilize a remote inflation device, and insure that all persons are clear of the trajectory area (**See Figure 1**).

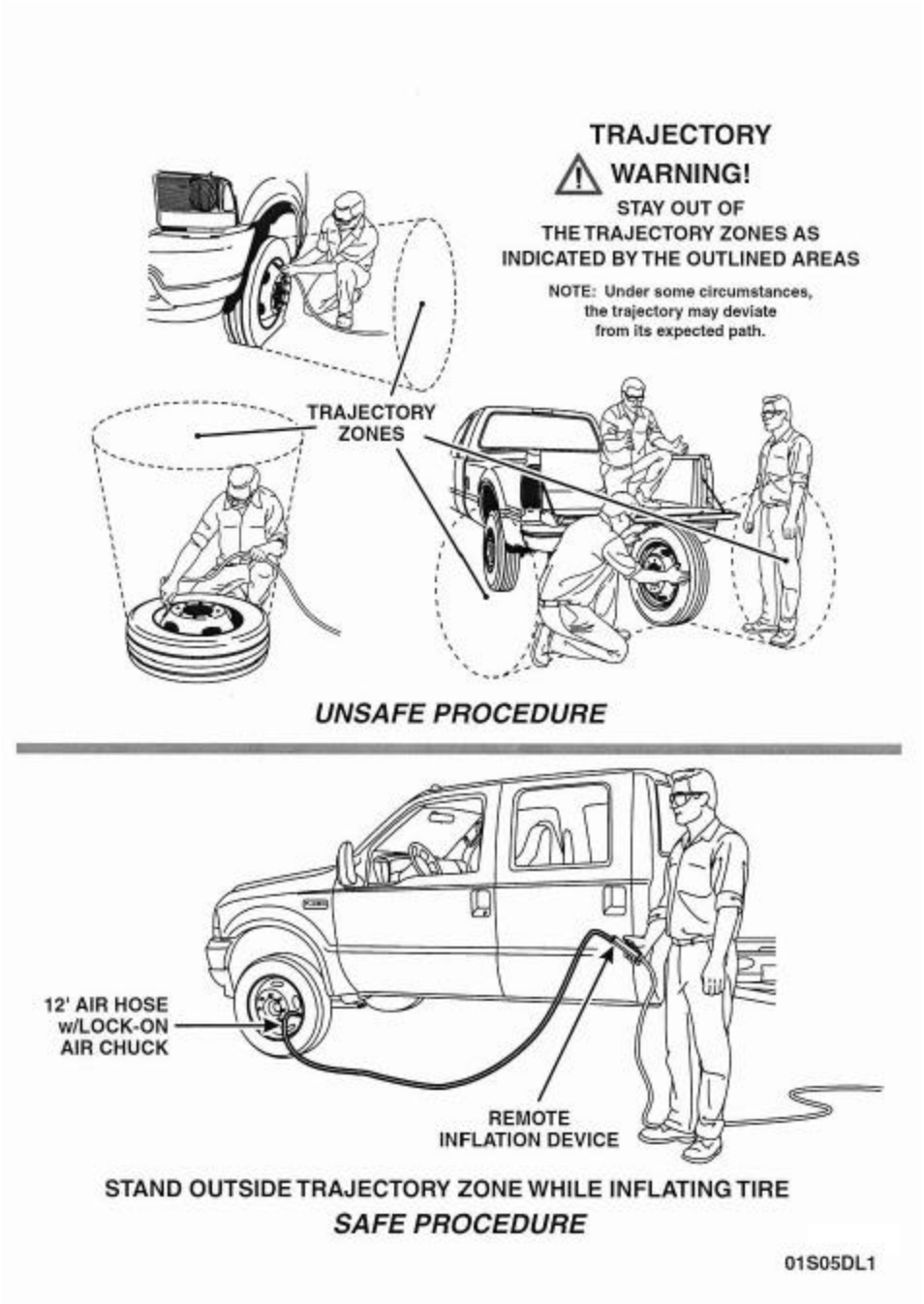


Figure 1 Illustrates **unsafe** (upper section), and **safe** (lower section) inflation techniques

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer. Your dealer will inspect each valve stem on your vehicle and, if necessary, replace the valve stem and tire of the affected wheel. In addition, your dealer will check and adjust your tire pressure to the proper specification.

Checking torque on lug nuts after the repair…

If your dealer determines that a valve stem is leaking, the repair will require the lug nuts of the affected wheel to be removed, reinstalled, and torqued to specification. Ford Motor Company recommends that the lug nut torque be rechecked at 100 miles (161 km) and again at 500 miles (800 km) after the repair. Follow the procedure outlined in your Owner's Guide, or return your vehicle to the dealer, to have the lug nut torque checked.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling requirements, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 01S05. When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid valve stem repairs made before the date of this letter (or after the date of the this letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Tire replacement that resulted from a leaking valve stem is also refundable. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

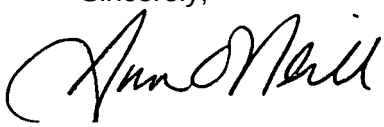
You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-888-327-4236 or 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs